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Office of Science and Technology Policy  
Executive Office of the President  
2415 Eisenhower Avenue  
Alexandria, VA 22314

*Submitted by email to* [REDACTED]

Re: Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Every lab working at the frontier of AI has *agents* in their sights. The reason they do, and why we should care, is that agents finally return control to people over their digital lives.

The significance is breathtaking. Businesses will be able to access their data wherever it lives and in whatever form it takes to actually solve their problems. Individuals will have tools that do what they need – loyal to them, not a company with its own incentives to control and profit off its users.

Agents today may seem rudimentary or clumsy, but that is also how personal computing looked when it crept onto a stage once dominated by mainframes. Over time, the power of machines that anyone could use led to an eclipsing of everything that preceded them.

We are at a similar juncture with agents, but unlike with personal computers, where they emerged as alternatives to a previous paradigm, computing today depends heavily on the platforms that control what we do online.

*Because of this, the primary obstacle to realizing the promise of AI agents may be legal, not technical.*

A small handful of companies dominate our devices and communications. Two operating systems account for more than 99% of U.S. mobile market share. Social media and messaging platforms are controlled by a handful of very few players. A long tail of vital services in other areas of our lives, from healthcare to retail to financial services, has seen dramatic consolidation.

And every one of them can deny access to an AI agent working for us simply by deciding to do so.

There are profound reasons to prevent them from strangling AI's greatest potential in its infancy.

It is astonishing that we are on a path where incumbent technology platforms could self-preference away the most promising future for AI, with implications for the industry, U.S. competitiveness, and our geopolitical reach. We've seen what happens when we let the incumbent players use their dominance in one technology to stymie the potential of challengers; if we want to see AI fully realized, we cannot let this repeat.

On a moral level, our digital lives should belong to us, not whichever corporation wields the greatest power at any given time. If an elderly patient could benefit from an agent that understood her appointment schedule, personal proclivities, and mobility constraints to nudge her whenever she needed, why should she depend on someone else's permission to allow that agent to act on *her* behalf with *her* data?

For the past decade our digital lives have been dictated by a handful of companies, controlling the contours of how we experience the internet and connect. AI agents have the potential to disrupt this balance and place the power to control this experience in the hands of the consumer. Let us not squander this opportunity.

**The solution is to protect interoperability and access for AI agents, so that individuals can regain control over their data and digital lives without the worry of arbitrary restrictions.**

The benefit is multifold:

- Users, platforms, and agent developers will have a shared understanding of the rights of users and the permissibility of assistive tools
- No overly burdensome regulation is needed to spur the startup ecosystem to unlock competing approaches to AI agents
- Existing approaches to managing users can extend simply to agents
- The pernicious effects of monopolistic control will be substantially eroded by natural market forces instead of costly regulations and enforcement with the potential for negative side effects
- New business models, including subscription alternatives to ad-based services, will emerge, expanding user choice in a time where our options have been limited
- Assistive technologies, once primarily only the domain for users with disabilities, will have access to the entire general market, advancing these technologies at a much greater pace

## **About Imbue**

Imbue is a frontier AI research company developing advanced AI agents capable of reasoning and coding. Founded in October 2022, Imbue secured \$210 million in Series B funding at a \$1 billion valuation, with backing from industry leaders including NVIDIA, the Alexa Fund, and former Google CEO Eric Schmidt.